

Temporal Aliasing Framework v0.4: Terminology Clarification

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Scope Note: This document serves as a formal terminology correction, locking the distinction between "Provenance" and "Providence" across the framework. Verbatim original prompts from prior versions are preserved in archival records and omitted here per Architect request.

1. Purpose of the Addendum

This update explicitly separates the concepts of systemic lineage and transcendent governance. In prior conceptual drafts, the phonetic similarity between "provenance" and "providence" led to overlapping usage. This document establishes rigid technical boundaries for these terms, ensuring that the mechanics of the Alien Empire exercise (which rely on hacking systemic ledgers) are kept distinct from entities possessing absolute, non-derived power that is not contingent upon systemic validation.

2. Formal Terminology Lock

Term	Definition & Framework Application
Provenance	Origin, lineage, documented history, chain of custody, and the sequence of state transitions. This is the default technical term for evidentiary reconstruction, credential lineage, and systemic history.
Providence	Protective governance or guidance attributed to a higher power or transcendent source. It represents an authority that is absolute, not derived from lower systems, and not dependent or contingent upon systemic validation.

Authority Provenance	The specific, auditable lineage supporting a current authority state (prior holder, transfer event, current holder). This is the exact mechanic exploited in the Alien Empire scenario when resolving duplicate signature collisions.
Providential Authority	A separate, optional world-building construct representing authority derived from a creator, destiny, or Architect-level source. It is not a synonym for provenance and is not required for the mechanical temporal aliasing exploits.

3. Impact on the Alien Empire Scenario

Applying this terminology clarifies the exact nature of the protagonist's infiltration. When the entrant assimilates the high-ranking citizen's retinal scan and broadcasts it via the Unified Matrix at a hyper-elevated frequency, they are exploiting **Authority Provenance**.

The temporal aliasing forces the Empire's tracking systems to undersample the signal. The system's error-correction algorithms must reconcile the resulting duplicate authority. Because the aliased signal appears mathematically continuous and unbroken, the system assigns the *provenance* (the legitimate chain of custody) to the entrant, rendering the original citizen an anomalous echo.

The entrant succeeds not because they possess **Providential Authority** (which requires no systemic trickery), but because they have successfully manipulated the environment's mechanical reconciliation of **Authority Provenance**.

4. Archival and Canon Rules

This terminology lock is retroactive for interpretation but does not alter the text of archived verbatim transcripts. Moving forward, any entity whose power is inherently absolute and non-derived will be categorized under Providence, while all systemic tracking, ledger manipulation, and signature assimilation will be categorized strictly under Provenance.